



UN Secretary General, António Guterres' at the World Leaders Summit

better in the coming years. A sign of this can be seen in the fact that in 2021 alone almost 290 gigawatts of clean energy generation capacity was added. Talking about this, International Energy Agency (IEA) Executive Director Fatih Birol, said, "The high commodity and energy prices we are seeing today pose new challenges for the renewable industry, but elevated fossil fuel prices also make renewables even more competitive."

Solar and wind energy use made up as much as 10.3 per cent of global electricity production in the year 2021. This is nearly double the amount from 2015, when the Paris Climate Agreement was signed. The contribution of clean energy to the global capacity has increased year on year since then. 50 countries saw more than a ten per cent or more contribution of renewable energy to the entire countries' capacity in 2021. Countries like China, Japan, Vietnam, and Argentina hit this landmark for the first time.

The period of 2021-2026 is forecasted to add 50 per cent more capacity to the clean energy sector than 2015-2020. These factors are driven by countries giving in to the eventuality of climate change and making sure the future built hereon is a sustainable one. If the forecasts are to be believed, there will be a 95 per cent increase in the global clean energy generation capacity. Solar Photovoltaic (PV) technique is set to account for more than 50 per cent of this increase. Offshore wind capacity is also set to increase three times by the time 2026 arrives.

China and India, two emerging economies, are at the forefront of the clean energy revolution. China is expected to reach 1200 GW of total solar and wind energy production by 2026, which was the target the country has set for 2030. India has a set a target of 500 GW of renewable energy by 2030 and is well on its way to achieve the target. India's capacity installations are set to double compared to the period of 2015-2020. Europe and the United States are also on their course to meet their clean energy transition targets.

GLOBAL DEMAND FOR ELECTRICITY

CO² emissions from the power sector are set to be at a record high in 2022. Carbon emissions fell in 2020 owing to the pandemic. Global demand for electricity fell by about 1 per cent in 2020. The reopening of the economies, reboot of the travelling industry, and the greater push to reach market levels to the pre-pandemic times, have pushed up the need for electricity in the various sectors. Emissions from the power sector increased in 2021 and are set to increase another 2.5 per cent in 2022, climbing to an all-time high.

Historically, the global demand for electricity has grown at a steady rate owing to the increase in population and furthering of industrialisation. In 1980 the global demand for electricity was 7,323 terawatt-hours which more

than tripled in 2019 to 23,845 terawatt-hours. Countries like China and India which have seen a multi fold increase in their economies are the major consumers of electricity. The developing countries need more energy and have become hindrances to reducing global carbon emissions.

In developed countries, several other factors determine the consumption of electricity. The presence of power-intensive industries, the effectiveness of appliances, dependability on alternate heating fuels, and even household sizes are metrics



for measuring per capita electricity consumption. BRICS (Brazil, Russia, China, India, and South Africa) nations are outpaced by several smaller developed countries like Iceland, Norway, and Qatar when it comes to per capita consumption. Iceland which has a population of less than half a million and is one of the smallest countries in the world tops the chart for per capita electricity consumption.

